

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X
CHELSEA ROJAS,

Plaintiff,

-against-

SUMMONS

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD POLICE OFFICER
KRISTEN LANE, Shield No. 16447, and POLICE
OFFICERS JOHN DOES NUMBERS ONE THROUGH
TEN,

Index No.:

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of Incident

Defendants.

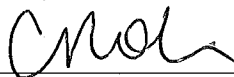
Plaintiff designates Kings
County as the place of trial.

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To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
June 4, 2020

Yours, etc.



CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC
CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.
Attorney for Plaintiff
30 Broad Street Suite 702
New York, New York 10004
(646)-524-6026

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

NYPD POLICE OFFICER KRISTEN LANE, Shield No. 16447, NYPD PSA 3, 25
Central Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11206

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS----- X
CHELSEA ROJAS,

Plaintiff,

INDEX NO.:VERIFIED COMPLAINT

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD POLICE OFFICER
KRISTEN LANE, Shield No. 16447, and POLICE
OFFICERS JOHN DOES NUMBERS ONE THROUGH
TEN,**JURY TRIAL DEMANDED**Defendants
----- X

Plaintiff CHELSEA ROJAS, by his attorneys, Caitlin Robin & Associates, PLLC, as and for his Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of Plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the First, Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On January 22, 2020, at approximately 9:00 a.m., plaintiff CHELSEA ROJAS, while lawfully inside her apartment located at 101 Humboldt Street in Brooklyn, New York, when she was subjected to an unlawful stop, question, frisk, search, false arrest, and false imprisonment by the defendant New York City police officers. In addition, Plaintiff was subjected to a First Amendment retaliation claim when Defendants refused to allow Plaintiff to breast feed or pump her milk, or take her to a hospital, causing permanent physical injury. Plaintiff was then unlawfully imprisoned at the 90th Precinct Police Station and Kings Central Booking for approximately thirty hours until plaintiff was arraigned in Criminal Court, charged with crimes she did not commit, and released on her own recognizance. Plaintiff was denied the right to due process and a fair trial until all charges against plaintiff were dismissed and sealed on or about February 13, 2020. Plaintiff was deprived of her constitutional and common law rights when the individual defendants unlawfully stopped, questioned, frisked, searched, confined, retaliated against, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned, and denied plaintiff the right to due process and a fair trial in violation of the First, Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff CHELSEA ROJAS is a resident of the state of New York.
3. NYPD POLICE OFFICER KRISTEN LANE, Shield No. 16447, is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.
4. NYPD POLICE OFFICER KRISTEN LANE, Shield No. 16447, was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 79th Precinct.
5. NYPD POLICE OFFICER KRISTEN LANE, Shield No. 16447, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.
6. New York City Police Officers John Does #1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.
7. Police Officers John Does #1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.
8. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.
9. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.
10. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the CITY OF NEW YORK in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.
11. In accordance with New York State law and General Municipal Law Section 50, plaintiff testified at a hearing held pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H on April 29, 2020.
12. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and THE CITY OF NEW YORK has failed to pay or adjust the claims.

13. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

14. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

15. On January 22, 2020, at approximately 9:00 P.M., Plaintiff was lawfully present inside her apartment located at 101 Humboldt Street in Brooklyn, New York, when the defendant police officers unlawfully stopped, questioned, frisked, and falsely arrested Plaintiff without probable cause or legal justification.

16. Plaintiff had just given birth to her son on January 14, 2020, who was one week old when Defendants came to her apartment.

17. Plaintiff was breast-feeding her son when the Defendants knocked on the door of her apartment.

18. Plaintiff went to the door, opened it slightly, and told Defendant Officers, "I need a minute to put some clothes on."

19. Plaintiff was breastfeeding her son wearing a robe, with no undergarments.

20. When Plaintiff went to close the door, in order to get dressed, Defendant Officers put their foot in the door to stop it from closing.

21. Defendants did not allow Plaintiff to get dressed, and instead immediately handcuffed her.

22. At no time relevant herein did Plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law in any way, nor did the police officer have an objective reason to accuse Plaintiff of committing a crime or violating the law in any way.

23. Nevertheless, Plaintiff was unlawfully arrested and handcuffed by defendant officers without legal justification or probable cause.

24. Plaintiff did not resist arrest.

25. Plaintiff begged the Defendant Officers to allow her to finish breast feeding, or to alternatively bring a pump with her so she could pump the milk out.

26. Defendants refused to allow Plaintiff to breast feed, pump, or even get a sports bra to cover herself.

27. Plaintiff was transported from her home to the 90th Precinct.

28. Plaintiff's breasts were leaking in the car to the precinct, because she had just given birth, and was producing a lot of milk.

29. When Plaintiff got to the 90th Precinct, she continually asked to be allowed to pump her breasts because her breasts were hurting and leaking with milk.

30. Defendants refused to allow her to pump.

31. Plaintiff also asked multiple times to be taken to a hospital because her breasts hurt so much and were leaking milk, but the Defendants refused to take her to the hospital.

32. Plaintiff's breasts began to turn purple, become hard, and extremely swollen, from the lack of pumping.

33. Plaintiff was then transported from the 90th Precinct to Kings County Central Bookings.

34. The defendant police officers provided the District Attorney's Office with the false, misleading and/or incomplete information that Plaintiff committed a crime.

35. At central bookings, Plaintiff repeatedly asked for medical attention for her breasts, which were engorged and in extreme pain, but was repeatedly denied.

36. Plaintiff leaked milk through her clothes and all over the floor of the cell at Central Bookings.

37. On January 23, 2020 after 30 hours in unlawful custody, plaintiff was arraigned in Kings County Criminal Court, charged with crimes that the defendant officers had no basis to allege that she committed and was released from custody.

38. When Plaintiff was released from custody she went to Woodhull Hospital Emergency Room to be treated for the injuries to her breasts.

39. Plaintiff also met with her private lactation specialist midwife, Holly Weiner, to be treated for the injuries to her breasts.

40. Plaintiff was unable to breastfeed after this unlawful arrest because of the damage to her breasts.

41. Plaintiff's son was unable to get the nourishment of breast milk from his mother because of the Defendants unlawful actions.

42. All charges were subsequently dismissed and sealed against Plaintiff on February 13, 2020.

43. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of Plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent their fellow officers from unjustifiably searching, seizing, assaulting, battering, using excessive force, falsely arresting and imprisoning, and denying plaintiff the right to due process and a fair trial

44. The unlawful, search, seizure, assault, battery, use of excessive force, false arrest and imprisonment, and denial of plaintiff's right to a fair trial by the individually named defendants caused Plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights

45. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 44 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

46. The individually named police officer defendants while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused Plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, and falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of Plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

47. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, psychological and economic injuries.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment

48. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 47 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

49. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and, in fact, confined Plaintiff, and Plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, Plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

50. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

51. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

52. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

53. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Stop, Question, and Frisk

54. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 53 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

55. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop, questioning and frisk employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

56. The conduct of defendants in stopping, frisking, and searching Plaintiff was performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.

57. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York.

58. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

59. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Search

60. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 59 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

61. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and search employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

62. Defendants lacked probable cause to search Plaintiff.

63. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York.

64. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

65. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

66. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fifth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights

Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process

67. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 66 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein

68. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

69. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

70. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

71. In withholding/creating false evidence against Plaintiff CHELSEA ROJAS, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, defendants violated Plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to

be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

72. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff CHELSEA ROJAS, sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, lost earnings and deprivation of her constitutional rights.

73. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

74. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

75. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, and psychological injuries.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligence

76. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 75 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

77. Defendants owed a duty of care to Plaintiff.

78. To the extent defendants claim that the injuries to Plaintiff by the defendant police officers was unintentionally caused and that the force used by the defendants against her was unintentional, then the defendants breached that duty of care by failing to provide medical attention and allow her to either breast feed or pump her breast milk.

79. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York.

80. All of the foregoing occurred without any fault or provocation by Plaintiff.

81. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

82. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

83. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

First Amendment Retaliation Claim

84. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs 1 through 83 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

85. Plaintiff engaged in speech and activities that were protected by the First Amendment, ie breastfeeding.

86. Defendants' retaliatory actions were motivated or substantially caused by Plaintiff's constitutionally protected speech or activities.

87. Defendants' retaliatory actions against Plaintiff resulted in the initiation of criminal charges against her and the deprivation of her liberty.

88. Defendants' retaliatory actions adversely affected Plaintiff's protected speech or activities by chilling her desire to further engage in such protected speech or activities.

89. Accordingly, Plaintiff's rights to engage in protected speech and activities, guaranteed under the First Amendment, were violated by defendants.

90. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Deliberate Indifference to Medical Needs

91. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 90 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

92. Defendants despite being aware that Plaintiff was suffering through severely engorged breasts and related pain while in their custody and required medication and additional treatment from medical professionals, they delayed Plaintiff's medical treatment and refused to administer and properly procure, immediate and adequate medical attention.

93. The delay in medical treatment to Plaintiff's injuries resulted in permanent additional ongoing anxiety attacks as well as an inability to breastfeed her son in the future all of which would have been prevented if Plaintiff received treatment in a timely manner.

94. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York.

95. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

96. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

97. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, and psychological injuries.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution

98. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 97 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

99. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the laws of the State of New York and New York State common law.

100. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against Plaintiff.

101. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against Plaintiff and for each of the charges for which she was prosecuted.

102. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in Plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned dates.

103. Plaintiff was subjected to a post-arraignment deprivation of liberty sufficient to implicate plaintiff's Fourth Amendment rights.

104. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

105. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

106. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, and psychological injuries.

ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress

107. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 106 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

108. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to Plaintiff, CHELSEA ROJAS. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

109. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed Plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

110. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York.

111. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

112. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

113. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, and psychological injuries.

TWELTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision

114. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 113 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

115. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise

defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

116. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, and psychological injuries.

THIRTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

117. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 116 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

118. The defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

119. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

120. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, she was put in fear of her safety, and she was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

121. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York.

122. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

123. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

124. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, and psychological injuries.

JURY DEMAND

125. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff CHELSEA ROJAS demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law. That the Plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated: New York, New York
June 4, 2020

By: 
CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.
CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC
Attorney for Plaintiff
30 Broad Street Suite 702
New York, New York 10004
(646)-524-6026

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

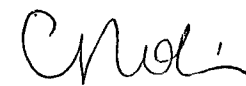
NYPD POLICE OFFICER KRISTEN LANE, Shield No. 16447, NYPD PSA 3, 25
Central Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11206

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

CAITLIN ROBIN, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a member of the law firm of **CAITLIN ROBIN AND ASSOCIATES PLLC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because Plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
June 4, 2020



CAITLIN ROBIN